

IIT Delhi Esports & Gaming Ecosystem

SECONDARY RESEARCH & MARKET FEASIBILITY BRIEF

1. The IIT Delhi Campus Context

The foundation for an esports, community, and marketplace ecosystem at IIT Delhi already exists, supported by both institutional initiatives and student culture. Building a centralized hub leverages these existing touchpoints:

- **Organized Competitive Culture:** The Department of Management Studies (DMS) at IIT Delhi officially hosts "Esports Fury," an event designed for gaming enthusiasts to compete across virtual platforms. This demonstrates a validated, captive audience looking for competitive engagement.
- **Academic & Institutional Backing:** IIT Delhi's Department of Design houses the G.A.M.E.S. lab, which features a growing library of digital and tabletop games used for teaching and research, normalizing gaming within the academic environment.

2. Macro Market Indicators (India)

Broad demographic research supports the financial viability of a collegiate gaming marketplace. The Indian gaming market has shifted from a niche hobby to a mainstream entertainment and social pillar, heavily driven by the purchasing power of students and young professionals.

\$9.1 Billion

PROJ. MARKET VALUE (2029)

19.6%

ESTIMATED CAGR

517 Million

PROJ. PLAYER BASE (2025)

The 16–24 age bracket represents the highest engagement tier nationally, with 65% indicating strong familiarity and active participation in online gaming. Furthermore, 30% of parents now actively support their children's gaming habits, reducing historical friction around gaming purchases.

3. Gen Z Behavioral & Engagement Data

Recent studies, including a May 2025 CyberMedia Research (CMR) report and the Lenovo & Esports Club Survey, reveal critical insights into how the target demographic interacts with gaming ecosystems. These metrics dictate when and how a campus marketplace should operate.

Metric Focus	Key Data Point	Strategic Implication
Time Spent	74% of Gen Z gamers spend 6+ hours weekly playing.	High platform retention; frequent return visits.
Peak Activity	Highest traffic occurs between 10 PM and 2 AM.	Prime time for campus tournaments and flash sales.
Media Consumption	71% regularly watch gaming content; 66% watch livestreams.	Community spaces must feature watch-parties.
Device Preference	90.4% are Mobile-first (PC: 6.1%, Console: 3.5%).	Marketplace must stock mobile gaming accessories.

Social Lobbies as the New Campus Square: Multiplayer titles (BGMI, Valorant) have evolved into primary social stages. In-game voice chats are frequently used by students to discuss exams, homework, and peer relationships, effectively replacing traditional social platforms late at night.

4. Strategic Roadmap & Takeaways

Based on the data, the pitch for the IIT Delhi marketplace should be built around three core pillars:

- **Consolidation of Campus Fragmentation:** Students are already participating in fragmented, isolated events (like Esports Fury). The platform must act as the persistent, centralized community hub that connects these disparate groups.
- **Targeted Monetization:** With 99% of dedicated Indian gamers active on social media (Instagram, Snapchat) and exhibiting rising purchasing power, a localized marketplace renting or selling hardware, merchandise, and premium tournament access is highly viable.
- **Beyond Just Playing:** Because over 70% of Gen Z gamers consume media rather than strictly playing, the physical/digital campus space must prioritize content creation. Podcasting setups, livestreaming tools, and comfortable watch-party zones will drive higher foot traffic than simple tournament brackets.